

Follow the instructions on each screen and press ‘Next’ to continue. You will see a screen, ‘Other Internet connection methods...’. This lets you to choose the method of connecting to the Internet. Select the first option, click ‘Next’, and click ‘Finish’ to exit the wizard. You can now access the Internet from other systems on the network.

You can also use third party software such as Proxy+, Proxy-Pro Professional GateKeeper, Squid, CCProxy, etc., to share an Internet connection. These proxies not only allow you to share your Net connection, they also help log the sites visited, the bandwidth used, and cache frequently-visited Web pages.

Logs are useful for monitoring Web pages, and will tell you who’s visiting what site. Though this sounds like snooping, you can never be too careful, especially when there are children in the family.

Caching is perhaps the most useful thing for those on limited usage Internet connections. Caching helps conserve bandwidth by not contacting the Internet for recently-visited Web pages, thus resulting in not just bandwidth savings but also an enhanced user experience—pages load faster! Usually, these proxies are easy to install, and have a good navigable interface.

11.8 Troubleshooting

Though networking in Windows XP is easy, there could be times when you face problems with your LAN. The basic problem, usually, is an improper physical connection. To check if there is a connectivity problem with your LAN, check the light on the LAN card (which can be located behind your cabinet). If the LEDs are glowing or blinking, there’s no physical connectivity problem with your LAN. If the LEDs are off, there is a connectivity problem—check for loose connections at joints and also check if the card is properly inserted into the PCI slot on the motherboard.